Advanced & Post Reading Material (APRM)
EPP- I, 2025-26 GLA U, Mathura
Module-II (Verbal Skills)
Types of Sentences in English

Introduction
A **sentence** is a group of words that expresses a single, complete thought. It includes a subject and a verb and can be used to make statements, ask questions, give instructions, issue commands, or make requests. When a sentence is written, it begins with a capital letter and ends with a full stop, question mark or an exclamatory mark.

Difference between a Phrase, a Clause and a Sentence

Phrase: A phrase is a collection of words that functions together as a unit but does not contain both a subject and a verb.
A phrase cannot stand alone as a complete thought.

- *in the garden* (prepositional phrase)
- *the tall boy* (noun phrase)

Note: Please refer to Phrases and Clauses APRM for detailed information.

Clause
A **clause** is a group of words that **contains the combination of a subject and a verb**. Some clauses can stand alone as complete thoughts, while others cannot.

- *She sings well.* (independent clause - complete thought)

It can be used as a sentence.

- *because he was late* (dependent clause - incomplete thought)

It cannot be used as a sentence.

Sentence
A **sentence** is a group of words that **expresses a complete thought**. It always has at least one independent clause.

- *The sun rises in the east.* (simple sentence)
- *Although it was raining, we went for a walk.* (complex sentence)

A sentence can be classified in two ways:

i. Functional Classification (on the basis of its communicative function/usage)
ii. Structural Classification (on the basis of its structure/syntax)

i. <u>Functional Classification</u>

Sentences on the basis of their **communicative function** or purpose are of **five** main types**.**

1.) Declarative Sentence (States facts, information, etc.)
A declarative sentence **makes a statement** or provides information. It is the most common sentence type in both speech and writing.
Subject + Verb (+ Other Elements)

It ends with a period (.)

1. The library opens at ten o'clock every morning.

2. Climate change affects global weather patterns significantly.

3. Shakespeare wrote numerous plays during the Elizabethan era.
4. Water boils at 100 degrees Celsius.
5. Students at GLA University require 75% attendance to appear in their end-term examination.

2.) **Interrogative Sentence (Asks questions)**

An interrogative sentence **asks a question** to elicit information or confirmation.
Auxiliary/Modal + Subject + Main Verb? OR Wh-word + Auxiliary + Subject + Verb?
It ends with a question mark (?).

Types:

- **Yes/No Questions:** Expect affirmative or negative responses
  Examples:
  Have you completed the assignment for tomorrow's class?
  Yes, I have. Or
  No, I haven't.

  Do you study Computer Science Engineering?
  Yes, I do.
  No, I don't.

  Can renewable energy replace fossil fuels completely?
  Yes, it can.
  No, it cannot.

- **Wh-Questions:** Use **who**, **what**, **when**, **where**, **why**, **how**
  Examples:
  Why do birds migrate during winter seasons?
  Where did you purchase that book?
  Who lives with you?

- **Indirect-Questions:** An indirect question is a question embedded inside another sentence (often a declarative or interrogative sentence). Instead of asking directly, it makes the question more polite or formal. We do not use two interrogative structures in one sentence.
  Do you know where the nearest bank is? (**not** Do you know where is the nearest bank?)
  Can you tell me how this machine works? (**not** Can you tell me how does this machine work?)
  I don't know why he left so suddenly. (**not** I don't know why did he leave so suddenly?)
  May I please know what your name is? (**not** May I please know what is your name?)

4.) Exclamatory Sentences (Expresses emotion)
An exclamatory sentence **expresses strong emotion, surprise, or emphasis**.

What/How + (Adjective/Adverb) + Subject + Verb! OR Independent clause with emotional emphasis!
It ends with an exclamation mark (!)

i. What a magnificent performance that was!
ii. How quickly time passes during vacation!
iii. That sunset is absolutely breathtaking!
iv. What an incredible achievement for humanity!
v. How generous of you to donate so much!

5.) Optative Sentences (Expresses wishes or prayers)
An optative sentence expresses a wish, hope, or prayer. It often begins with **"May"**, **"Wish"**, or **"Let"**, and conveys goodwill or desire.
May/Wish/Let + Subject + Verb + (Object/Complement)
It ends with a period **(.)** or sometimes an exclamation mark **(!)** for emphasis.

i. May you achieve great success in life!
ii. Wish you a joyful and prosperous New Year!
iii. May peace prevail across the world.
iv. Let happiness fill your heart every day.
v. May your efforts be rewarded with excellence!

Structural Classification
Sentences can be classified based on their **internal grammatical structure** and the number and types of clauses they contain.

1.) Simple Sentence
One independent clause
A simple sentence contains **one independent clause** with a subject and a predicate expressing a complete thought.
One subject + One verb (+ Complements/Modifiers)

1. The committee approved the proposal unanimously.
2. Birds sing melodiously during early morning hours.
3. Students study diligently for their final examinations.
4. The ancient castle stands majestically on the hill.
5. Technology changes rapidly in modern society.

2.) Compound Sentence
Multiple independent clauses

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A compound sentence contains **two or more independent clauses** joined by coordinating conjunctions or semicolons.
Independent Clause + Coordinating Conjunction + Independent Clause

Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS): for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so

1. The weather was cold, but we decided to go hiking anyway.
2. She studied medicine, and her brother pursued engineering.
3. You can take the bus, or you can walk to school.
4. The movie was entertaining, yet it received mixed reviews.
10. The project deadline is approaching, so we must work efficiently.

3.) Complex Sentence
Independent + dependent clause(s)
A complex sentence contains **one independent clause and one or more dependent (subordinate) clauses.**
Independent Clause + Subordinating Conjunction + Dependent Clause
OR
Subordinating Conjunction + Dependent Clause + Independent Clause

Common Subordinating Conjunctions: because, although, since, when, if, while, unless, after, before, as, though, until, where, whereas

i. Although the task was difficult, she completed it successfully.
ii. The students left the auditorium when the lecture ended.
iii. If you practice regularly, you will improve your skills.
iv. Because the traffic was heavy, we arrived late for the meeting.
v. We will proceed with the plan unless someone objects strongly.

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